

Engine data & public shop — reference notes

Autowagen Master — where engine-related data lives, how subcategories work, and how the website reads it. For owners and staff keeping documentation.

1. Where the program reads data from

All shop pages use **PHP + PDO** (`config/config.php`) to read one **MySQL/MariaDB** database (on Laragon usually `autowagen_master`; on hosting, the name in `secrets.live.php`). There is no separate “engine server” — engines on the site are **normal inventory rows** plus **EPC links**.

Topic	What you maintain in the app	Database
Part for sale (name, price, qty, photos...)	Inventory → Edit part	parts, part_photos
“This part is an engine / cooling / ... catalogue tag”	Same screen — EPC variant picker → saves links	part_epc_links → epc_variants → ... → epc_categories
Flat path for filtering (e.g. category slug engine)	Built from tree (not edited by hand)	View <code>epc_full_view</code>
Show on public website	Tick List on public website	parts.list_online (after <code>06b_web_shop.sql</code>)
Wrecks on Stripping stock	Master data → Vehicles + photos	vehicles, vehicle_photos

2. EPC tree — what “Engine” and subcategories really are

The catalogue is a **fixed-depth tree** (Stage 2). Each part can be linked to one or more **variants** (bottom level). The shop’s **Engines** section keeps any part whose link path includes the top category with slug `engine`.

Six levels (top → bottom)

- 1. **Category** — e.g. *Engine* (`epc_categories.slug = engine`)
- 2. **Subcategory** — e.g. Petrol, Diesel (`epc_subcategories`)
- 3. **Type** — e.g. Inline 4, V6 (`epc_types`)
- 4. **Subsystem** — e.g. Cooling, Lubrication (`epc_subsystems`)
- 5. **Component** — e.g. Radiator (`epc_components`)
- 6. **Variant** — e.g. OEM, Aftermarket (`epc_variants`) ← **what you pick for the part**

Example paths from the seed SQL (`sql/02_epc.sql`)

```
Engine
├── Petrol
│   └── Inline 4
│       ├── Cooling
│       └── Radiator → OEM | Aftermarket
```

└─ Lubrication → ...

Engine

└─ Diesel → ...

Brakes / Body ... (other top categories, not “engine” slug)

Your live tree may be larger if you ran optional expansion scripts (02b–02h). More subcategories = more precise tags, but the **shop Engines page** still groups everything whose `category_slug` is engine, regardless of Petrol/Diesel/Cooling, unless you add more shop filters later.

3. How a part gets into “Engines” on the website

1. Part exists in parts with `is_active, status = available, qty_on_hand > 0, list_online = 1`.
2. Row exists in `part_epc_links` linking `part_id` to some `variant_id`.
3. That variant joins through `epc_full_view` to a row where `category_slug = 'engine'`.

PHP file: `shop/category.php` — SQL joins `parts` → `part_epc_links` → `epc_full_view` and filters `efv.category_slug = :cat_slug` (for Engines, engine).

4. Engines menu — three extra “lanes” (same Engine category)

Besides **All engine listings**, the dropdown filters by **words in parts.name** (not by EPC subcategory level). Staff must use consistent titles.

Menu item	URL	Meaning (name keywords)
All engine listings	<code>category.php?slug=engine</code>	Every online part tagged under Engine in EPC
Engine parts (loose)	<code>...&line=parts</code>	Excludes titles that look like “complete engine” / “cylinder head” patterns
Complete engines / sub-units	<code>...&line=complete</code>	Title contains e.g. complete engine, long block, long motor, full engine, engine assembly, sub unit
Cylinder heads / bare	<code>...&line=heads</code>	Title contains e.g. cylinder head, cyl head, bare head, head bare

Code reference: `includes/shop_helpers.php` — `shop_normalize_engine_line()`, `shop_engine_line_sql_condition()`.

5. EPC vs lanes (important)

Layer	Decides
EPC tree (Petrol → Inline 4 → Cooling → Radiator → OEM)	Whether the part appears under the Engine shop category at all (and staff drill-down in admin)
Engines dropdown lane (<code>line=parts complete heads</code>)	Which shop submenu the part appears in — based on part name text only

To drive lanes from EPC instead of names in the future, you would add a field on parts (e.g. assembly class) or map EPC components — that would need a small schema + code change.

6. SQL files to remember

- `sql/02_epc.sql` — EPC tables + `epc_full_view` + seed Engine/Brakes/Body
- Optional: `sql/02b ... 02h` — more categories / subcategories (see `README_EPC_EXPANSION.txt`)
- `sql/04_inventory.sql` — `parts`, `part_epc_links`, `part_photos`
- `sql/06b_web_shop.sql` — `parts.list_online`, `shop_orders`, `shop_order_lines`
- `sql/06e_shop_guest_enquiries.sql` — guest Message inbox

7. Staff checklist (engines on the web)

1. Edit part → set name, price, qty, available.
2. Link EPC path that ends under **Engine** (any valid sub-path you use).
3. Tick **List on public website**.
4. For submenu lanes: set **part name** wording per section 4.
5. Upload photos; save.

8. Related printable guides in `docs/`

- `shop_staff_data_guide.html` — shop data overview for staff
- `client_training_index.html` — index of all training HTML
- `complete_system_manual.html` — full system walkthrough